

Threat Intelligence Report: Financial Credential Harvesting Campaign

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Case Reference: 2025-10-05-Japanese-phishing-email-0220-UTC

1. Executive Summary

An analysis was conducted on a sophisticated phishing campaign targeting Japanese consumers using the domain **plaickax.cn**. The campaign utilized **Base64 obfuscation** to bypass signature-based email filters. Forensic investigation reveals the infrastructure was registered in July 2025 and has since been placed on **clientHold**, indicating verified malicious activity or administrative suspension. This campaign is consistent with organized credential harvesting targeting financial PII.

2. Technical Indicators (IOCs)

Indicator Type	Value	Context/Analysis
Phishing Domain	plaickax.cn	Country-code Top Level Domain (ccTLD) frequently used in regional targeting.
Registrant Email	blumhardtlizaoo1817@gmail.com	High-entropy Gmail address; likely used for bulk domain registration.
Name Servers	ns7.alidns.com / ns8.alidns.com	Utilizing Alibaba Cloud infrastructure to host malicious landing pages.

Registration Date	July 10, 2025	Infrastructure was aged for several months before full-scale deployment.
Domain Status	clientHold	Confirmed deactivation by the registrar, validating the threat's malicious nature.

3. Forensic Methodology

- **De-obfuscation:** Decoded **Base64 encoded** email bodies using **CyberChef** to extract hidden HTML **href** links.
- **Infrastructure Pivot:** Conducted **WHOIS** and **DNS** lookups to identify the registrant (陈礼吉) and the Chinese-based registrar.
- **Reputation Analysis:** Attempted triage via **urlscan.io**; confirmed DNS resolution failure consistent with the current **clientHold** administrative status.

4. Strategic Recommendations for RBC

RBC analysts must remain vigilant against aged-domain attacks like this one. Recommended actions include:

- **Perimeter Hardening:** Instate a blocklist for the **.cn** TLD for non-essential business units if no legitimate regional traffic is expected.
- **Log Correlation:** Query **Splunk** for any historical outbound traffic to **plaickax.cn** to identify past successful connections.
- **Enhanced Monitoring:** Flag any new domain registrations utilizing Alibaba DNS (**alidns.com**) that target financial login keywords.

5. Conclusion

This campaign demonstrates the use of aged domains to bypass "newly registered domain" security filters. While the specific infrastructure analyzed is currently inactive, the registrant's tactics indicate an ongoing threat to financial institutions.